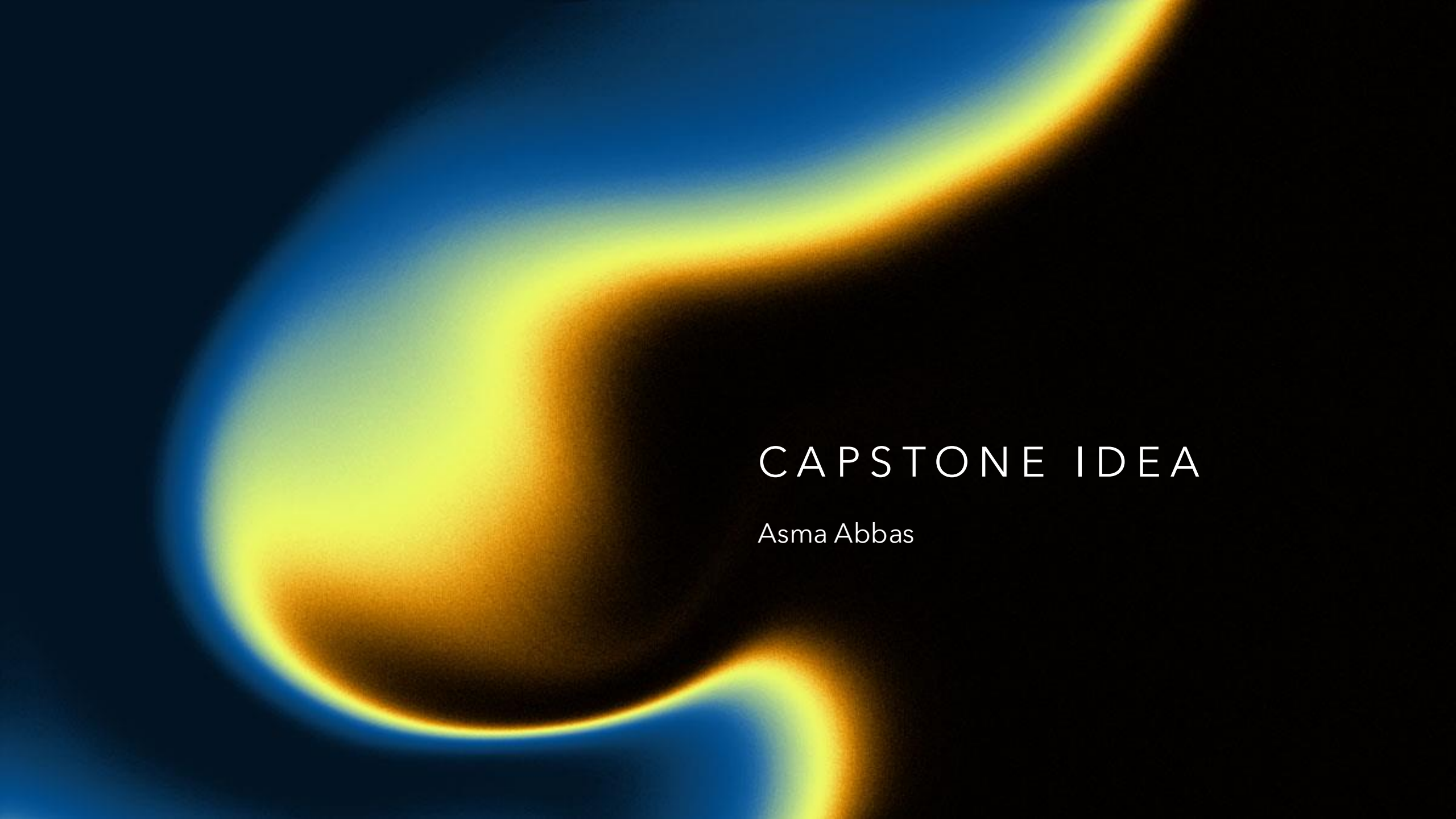




CAPSTONE IDEA

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INVESTIGATING GRADUATION RATES AND POVERTY RATES IN MONTGOMERY COUNTY

- **Motivation Type**
 - **Audience question**
- **Domain of interest:**
 - **Education, Public Policy, Equity**
- **Project motivation**
 - **I want to take a look at the relationship between poverty indicators and graduation rates in Montgomery County**
 - **I also want to see if other factors, like demographic (race/ethnicity) change this relationship at all**
 - **If we're able to discover a pattern and relationship between these variables, it might be able to aid and provide insight to educators for new policies that would support affected areas.**
- **It's important to observe this because education should not be a privilege, it is a social right. If we can properly understand structural inequities, we can also pivot towards a solution to support students that are at a risk of dropping out, or not making it to graduation.**



MAIN DATASET(S)

- https://opendata.maryland.gov/Demographic/Maryland-Counties-Socioeconomic-Characteristics-AC/is7h-kp6x/about_data

- This dataset is from opendata.maryland, and it contains data on multiple different socioeconomic factors for the state of Maryland and its counties.

- **Important variables**

- **Poverty rate**
- **Child poverty**
- **Household income**
- **Educational attainment**

- **Other datasets I might use would be:**

- <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSST5Y2022.S1701?q=Montgomery+County+Maryland+pov+erty>

- This dataset is from datacensus.gov, and it contains data on poverty rates in Maryland, along with other demographic factors.

- <https://www.montgomeryschoolsmd.org/school-profiles>

- This dataset has information based on specific schools within Montgomery County. It contains factors like school, student to staff ratio, graduation rates, and demographics.

POTENTIAL QUESTIONS



- How strongly are poverty indicators associated with highschool graduation rates in Montgomery County, and across Maryland.
 - How does the relationship change when accounting for race/ethnicity and school demographics?
 - Are there specific areas where poverty is linked to lower graduation rates?
 - Could community level income indicators project graduation outcomes?